

Uddannelsesmuligheder efter folkeskole



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Gambia. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

It's great that you're thinking carefully about your next step! Since you just finished primary school (in Denmark, that would mean *folkeskole* up to 9th or 10th grade), you now have several good options depending on your interests, strengths, and future goals. Let me break them down for you:

Main educational paths after folkeskole

1 Gymnasiale uddannelser (General upper secondary education)

These are good if you think you might want to go to university later:

- **STX (Studentereksamen)** – broad academic program, good for university entry, with focus areas like science, languages, social sciences, or arts.
- **HHX (Handelshøjskoleeksamen)** – focus on business, economics, marketing.
- **HTX (Teknisk studentereksamen)** – focus on technology, science, IT.
- **HF (Højere forberedelseseksamen)** – shorter (2 years), more practical, for those who want university options but maybe didn't love school.

✓ *Good choice if:*

You enjoy academic subjects, want flexibility, and might aim for higher education (university, business school, technical university, etc.)

2 Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational education / apprenticeships)

Combine school and practical work (you alternate between school and working at a company):

- Examples: carpenter, electrician, chef, hairdresser, mechanic, IT support, social care assistant, etc.
- You can always build on a vocational education with extra courses to get access to higher education later (eux, for example).

✓ *Good choice if:*

You like hands-on work, want to start earning earlier, or want a clear path to a specific career.

3 EUX (Vocational + studentereksamen combo)

Gives both a vocational qualification **and** the equivalent of a gymnasial exam.

✓ *Good if:* You want both practical skills + the option of going to university.

☀️ How to decide?

Ask yourself:

- What subjects do I enjoy most? (math, science, languages, business, creative arts, practical work...?)
- Do I prefer classroom learning or more hands-on experiences?
- Do I want to keep doors open for university later, or am I eager to start learning a trade?
- How do I feel about the length of study (2-3 years vs. 4 years)?

💡 Example paths

- 👉 If you like science, technology or IT → HTX or EUX with tech focus
- 👉 If you like business, economics → HHX
- 👉 If you're creative/artistic → STX with arts focus, or vocational education like graphic design
- 👉 If you're practical/hands-on → vocational education (maybe with EUX)

🌍 Tip for you as a Danish-Gambian student

Your multicultural background is a strength — languages, cultural understanding, and international perspective can open doors. If you're interested, you might consider paths that let you use that (like international business, languages, or social studies).

🔑 Next steps

- Talk to an *uddannelsesvejleder* (guidance counselor) at your school or the local *UU-vejledning* (Ungdommens Uddannelsesvejledning) — they can help you map out options.
- Visit open house events at gymnasier or vocational schools.
- Maybe do a short internship (*brobygning*) or introductory course to test a vocational program.

If you tell me more about:

- 👉 What subjects you like / don't like
- 👉 If you have hobbies or dreams for the future
- 👉 Whether you're aiming for university, job, or still unsure

... I can give you a more tailored recommendation! Would you like that? 😊